

EasySave Backup Software : User Manual

Version 3.0

Overview

EasySave is a professional backup tool available as both a console application and a graphical WPF interface. You can configure up to five backup jobs, each pointing to a source folder and a destination. Jobs can be run individually or all at once, and now run in parallel for maximum performance. EasySave supports local drives, external drives, and network shares (UNC paths).

Version 3.0 introduces parallel execution, priority file management, real-time pause/resume/stop controls, bandwidth protection for large files, automatic pause when business software is detected, single-instance CryptoSoft encryption, and an optional Docker-based log centralization service.

Launching the Application

Graphical Interface (WPF)

Run EasySave.WPF.exe for the full graphical experience. The interface is organized into three tabs: Jobs, Create, and Settings.

Console Mode

Run EasySave.exe with no arguments to open the interactive menu, or pass job arguments directly:

Mode	Command
Interactive menu	EasySave.exe
Run job 2	EasySave.exe 2
Run jobs 1 through 3	EasySave.exe 1-3
Run jobs 1 and 3 only	EasySave.exe 1;3

Graphical Interface (GUI)

Jobs Tab

The Jobs tab lists all configured backup jobs with a real-time progress bar for each one. From here you can:

- Select individual jobs using the checkboxes, then click Execute Selected, or click Execute All to launch all jobs simultaneously.
- Monitor live progress: each job card shows its current state (Active, Paused, Completed, etc.) and a percentage progress bar.
- Pause a running job, the pause takes effect after the current file finishes transferring.
- Resume a paused job to continue from where it stopped.
- Stop a job immediately. The current file transfer is cancelled and the job is marked Cancelled.
- Modify a job: rename it or change its source/target paths using the Modify button.

Note: When running multiple jobs at once, all jobs execute in parallel. You can control each job independently at any time.

Create Tab

Enter a job name, browse for source and target folders, tick the Differential checkbox if needed, then click Create. You may have up to 5 jobs at a time.

Settings Tab

The Settings tab lets you configure all global options. Click Save to apply. Available settings:

Setting	Description
Language	Interface language: English, French, Spanish, or Arabic.
Theme	Visual mode: Light (Claire) or Dark (Sombre).
Log Format	Choose JSON or XML for daily log files.
Log Destination	Where logs are saved: Local (PC only), Centralized (Docker server only), or Both.
Log Centralizer URL	Base URL of the Docker log server (e.g. http://log-server:5080). Only used when Destination is Centralized or Both.
File Extensions to Encrypt	Comma-separated list of extensions CryptoSoft will encrypt during backup (e.g. .txt, .docx, .pdf).
Encryption Key	Passphrase passed to CryptoSoft. Stored securely on your machine.
Business Software	Process names that will pause all backups when detected (e.g. calc, notepad).
Priority Extensions	File extensions that must be backed up before any non-priority file when running parallel jobs (e.g. .jpg, .xml).
Max Parallel Size (KB)	Files larger than this threshold cannot be transferred in parallel. Only one large file can transfer at a time. Default: 100 KB.

Creating a Backup Job

Field	Description
Job Name	A recognisable label such as "Weekly Docs" or "Project Archive".
Source Path	The folder to back up. Accepts local paths (C:\Documents) or UNC network paths (\\server\share).
Target Path	Where the backup is saved. The folder is created automatically if it does not exist.
Backup Type	Full : copies every file every time. Differential : copies only files changed since the last run.

Note: Jobs are saved automatically. They will still be there the next time you open EasySave.

Parallel Backup

Starting with version 3.0, all backup jobs run simultaneously when you use Execute All (or pass multiple job numbers on the command line). Each job runs on its own thread, so your total backup time is determined by the slowest job rather than the sum of all jobs.

The following rules govern how files are scheduled across parallel jobs:

Priority File Management

You can declare a list of priority file extensions in Settings (Priority Extensions). As long as any running job still has priority-extension files left to process, no other job may transfer a non-priority file. This ensures that high-value files are secured first.

- Priority files are processed immediately, regardless of how many other jobs are running.
- Non-priority files in all jobs wait until every job's priority queue is empty.
- Once all priority files across all jobs are done, non-priority transfers resume normally.

Large File Protection

To prevent a single large file from saturating your network or storage bandwidth, no two files larger than the configured Max Parallel Size (KB) threshold may be transferred at the same time.

- While a large file is transferring, other jobs may freely transfer smaller files (subject to the priority rule above).
- A second large file will wait until the first one completes, then begin immediately.
- The threshold is configurable in Settings. Default value is 100 KB.

Real-Time Job Controls

During a backup you can interact with each job individually or with all jobs at once:

Action	Scope	Behaviour
Pause	Single job or All	The job finishes copying the current file, then suspends. Progress is preserved.
Resume / Play	Single job or All	A paused job continues from exactly where it stopped.
Stop	Single job or All	The job stops immediately. The file currently being written is abandoned. State is set to Cancelled.

The progress bar on each job card shows the percentage of files remaining in real time. The current source and destination file paths are also displayed so you can see exactly what is being transferred.

Business Software Detection

EasySave monitors Windows processes in the background. If any application from your Business Software list is detected, all backup jobs are paused automatically. They resume as soon as that application is closed.

- If business software is already running when you try to launch a backup, the job will not start. A log entry is written recording which application blocked it.
- If business software opens while a backup is in progress, each job finishes transferring its current file and then pauses. All jobs resume automatically once the software is closed.
- The name of the blocking application is recorded in the daily log file for auditing purposes.

Note: Enter process names without the .exe extension in Settings (e.g. calc not calc.exe).

CryptoSoft Encryption

EasySave can automatically encrypt files during backup using CryptoSoft, an XOR-based encryption tool bundled with the application. Only files whose extension matches your configured list are encrypted; all other files are copied normally.

How It Works

- For each file that matches an encrypted extension, EasySave first copies the file to the target location, then calls CryptoSoft to encrypt it in place.
- The encryption time for each file is recorded in the daily log (encryptionTimeMs field).

- CryptoSoft is enforced as a single-instance application, it cannot run more than once simultaneously on the same machine. EasySave manages this automatically.

Configuring Encryption

Setting	Description
File Extensions to Encrypt	Extensions whose files will be passed to CryptoSoft (e.g. .txt, .docx, .pdf). Defaults to .txt, .docx, .pdf.
Encryption Key	The passphrase CryptoSoft uses. Stored in protected form on your machine. Change this from the default before using in production.

Note: CryptoSoft.exe must be present in %APPDATA%\EasySave\CryptoSoft\. If missing, backups continue but files are not encrypted.

Log Centralization (Docker)

EasySave 3.0 optionally sends log entries to a centralized Docker server in real time. This is designed for multi-server deployments where IT teams want to consolidate all backup logs in one place.

Log Destination Options

Option	Where logs are written
Local	Daily log file on this PC only (%APPDATA%\EasySave\Logs\YYYY-MM-DD.json).
Centralized	Docker log server only. No local file is written on this PC.
Both	Local file on this PC and the Docker log server simultaneously.

Centralized Log File

The Docker server maintains a single daily log file (YYYY-MM-DD.json) regardless of how many machines are sending data. Each log entry includes the machine name and Windows user name so individual users can be identified within the shared file.

Setting Up the Docker Server

- Ensure Docker Desktop (or Docker Engine on Linux) is installed on the server machine.
- From the EasySave installation folder, run: `docker-compose up -d`
- The log server starts on port 5080 by default.
- In EasySave Settings, set Log Destination to Centralized or Both, and enter the server URL (e.g. `http://log-server:5080`).

Note: Centralized logging runs in the background and will never interrupt or delay a backup, even if the server is temporarily unreachable.

Log & Status Files

Daily Log (YYYY-MM-DD.json or .xml)

Every file transfer is appended to the daily log as it happens. Each entry includes:

- Timestamp of the transfer
- Machine name and Windows user name
- Backup job name
- Source and destination file paths
- File size in bytes

- Transfer time in milliseconds (negative value indicates a failed transfer)
- Encryption time in milliseconds (0 if the file was not encrypted; negative if CryptoSoft failed to start)

Note: Log format (JSON or XML) is set in the Settings tab and applies to all future log files.

Real-Time Status (state.json)

Updated live while any backup is running. Open it at any time to see which jobs are active, how many files remain, and exactly which file is being processed. Located at %APPDATA%\EasySave\state.json.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Resolution
App starts then closes immediately	The .NET runtime is not installed. Download it from microsoft.com/dotnet .
Jobs disappear after restart	jobs.json is missing or corrupted. Delete it from %APPDATA%\EasySave\ and relaunch (the app recreates an empty list).
A job shows Paused unexpectedly	Business software may be detected, or a priority file rule is blocking non-priority transfers. Check your Settings and close any listed business applications.
Files are not encrypted	Confirm CryptoSoft.exe exists in the configured path and that the file extension is in the Encrypted Extensions list (lowercase, with a leading dot, e.g. .pdf).
Log Centralizer is unreachable	Check that Docker is running (docker ps) and that the Log Centralizer URL in Settings matches the server address and port. Backups will continue; log entries not delivered to the server are not retried.
encryptionTimeMs is -1 in the log	CryptoSoft failed to start. Verify the executable is present and the process has execute permission on that path.
Interface is in the wrong language	Change the language in Settings and click Save.